

90 SEC ACED PITCH · META L6 DE, ANALYTICS

I'm a Senior Data Engineering Leader

Currently leading Data and AI Engineering at a large omnichannel retailer, Thailand.
Target: Meta L6 — Product Analytics scale

NOW PROJECT IMPACT PAST META

2 weeks → 2 days

comparable work, JIRA measured

ACED vs generic present-past-future

GENERIC · LAUNDRY LIST

I worked at X, then Y, now Z...

- Technology laundry list, no scope signal
- No measurable proof, feels junior
- No hooks — interviewer doesn't know where to pull

Result: Interviewer asks random questions, you lose control of narrative

ACED · EVIDENCE FOR L6

Seniority + Specific achievement + Measurable impact + Breadcrumbs + Next move

- ✓ NOW: Senior Data + AI leader, 3 businesses scope
- ✓ PROJECT: Unified platform — architecture ownership
- ✓ IMPACT: 2w → 2d, JIRA measured, defensible
- ✓ PAST: Bank, PayPal, SCB, Lazada SG — scale + reliability
- ✓ META: Why IC track, product analytics

Key: Leave breadcrumbs — alignment, migrations, reliability — let interviewer pull

ANCHOR 1 · NOW

Senior Data Engineering leader, leading Data + AI Engineering



"I'm a senior Data Engineering leader, currently leading Data and AI Engineering at a large omnichannel retailer in Thailand."

WHAT TO EMPHASIZE

Senior, leader, Data + AI, large omnichannel

L6 SIGNAL

Scope = 3 businesses, not 1

RETAILER SCOPE

Retail Stores	E-com	B2B
POS + WMS	Lazada-like	Makro B2B

INTERVIEWER HEARS

Is he senior enough for L6? Owns multiple domains, cross-functional with business.

PROJECT — unified data platform

ANCHOR 2 · WHAT YOU BUILT

SCRIPT

"One of my key projects was leading the design and delivery of a unified data platform across retail stores, e-commerce, and B2B businesses."

BEFORE

- Data fragmented across POS, SAP, WMS, e-com
- Business metrics inconsistent — no single sales definition
- Engineering delivery slow, ad-hoc QA

L6 SIGNALS

- Cross-functional leadership with business leaders
- Architecture ownership — standardized data models
- Reliable pipelines + quality controls

1

Redesign architecture

Domain-driven design. Raw → Standard → Commercial marts. Clear ownership per domain.

2

Standardize models

Metric dictionary co-owned with business. Sales = net after VAT, ex-shipping, timing aligned.

3

Reliable pipelines

Snowflake + dbt + Airflow. Data contracts, idempotency, reconciliation framework (3 layers).

↗

Tech depth if asked

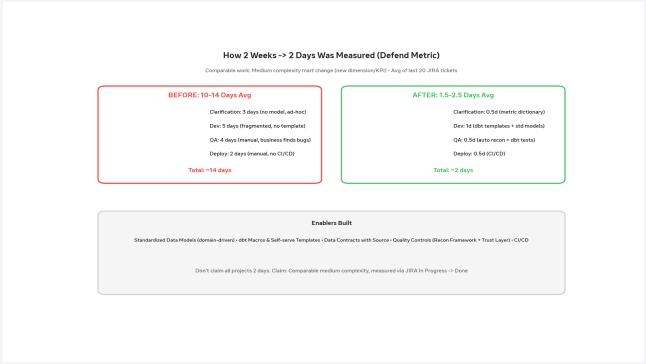
Snowflake + dbt macros, Airflow DAGs with data contracts, SCD2, SLAs, trust layer monitoring. No tool laundry list.

IMPACT — 2 weeks → 2 days

Anchor 3 · Measurable · Use only if you can explain measurement for comparable work

2 weeks → 2 days

Comparable medium complexity mart change



HOW TO SAY IT

"One of the biggest improvements was reducing delivery time for new data requirements from around two weeks to two days — for comparable medium-complexity work, measured via JIRA."

- **Standardized models**
- **dbt macros & templates**
- **Data contracts**
- **Quality + CI/CD**

BEFORE: ~14 DAYS AVG

Clarification	3d ad-hoc
Dev	5d no template
QA	4d manual
Deploy	2d manual

AFTER: ~2 DAYS AVG

Clarification	0.5d dictionary
Dev	1d templates
QA	0.5d auto
Deploy	0.5d CI/CD

HOW MEASURED · DEFEND IT

Time from JIRA creation → dataset available in prod. Avg last 20 tickets of same type: new dimension / KPI. Not all projects 2 days. Same complexity.

BE READY

If pushed: show JIRA In Progress → Done. Explain what changed: metric dictionary → less back-and-forth, dbt templates → dev faster, auto recon + tests → QA faster.

BREADCRUMB #1 · YOU LEFT IT DELIBERATELY

The hard part wasn't technology

"The most challenging part wasn't just the technology. It was aligning multiple business teams on common data definitions and ownership."

WHY L6

Shows socio-technical leadership, not just tech. Meta wants product + data + eng alignment. This is hook for "Tell me about influencing stakeholders who disagreed."

Socio-technical | RACI | Metric Dictionary

REAL STORY: SALES DEFINITION

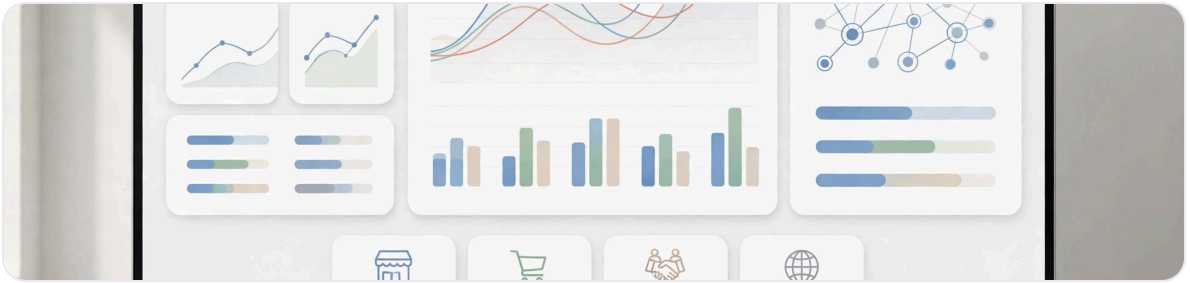
STORE	E-COM	B2B
Net sales, no VAT	**Gross + shipping**	**Plus back-margin**
Physical POS, offline only	Includes VAT, online orders	Timing diff, bulk

Workshops
Mapped 3 definitions, surfaced gap in joint session

RACI
Each KPI has owner: Sales = Commercial Head

Metric Dictionary
Co-owned doc, SQL example, sign-off

- **Interviewer will ask:** How did you influence stakeholders who disagreed? → You answer with above: workshops, data, neutral facilitator, let business decide with tradeoffs.



PAST — credibility for L6

Anchor 4 · Script: “Before that, I worked at Bank, PayPal, SC, Lazada SG — large-scale data engineering, platform modernization, analytics.”

BANK — REGULATED · 400TB

Teradata → Hadoop migration

Regulatory reporting, large-scale migration, stakeholder communication gap story

Mistake I own: Tech success but business not informed. Fixed with checkpoints + business sign-off. Changed my leadership.

PAYPAL — REAL-TIME · BILLIONS

Fraud ingestion — Scala/Akka

99.95% SLO, billions events, ramp-up playbook. 3 weeks to board demo.

Signal: Trace 3 events end-to-end, draw diagram, 12 specific Qs. Shipped 4 days early, $1.2M/mo fraud caught.

SCB — PAYMENTS · QUALITY

Payments double-count fix

3% error, shim layer, influence without authority

Conflict: Finance wanted full backfill (6w). Proposed 90d backfill = 92% impact at 18% cost. Math won.

LAZADA SG — E-COM · FAST MOVING

Marketplace — seller performance mart

Fast-changing req, metric validation gap

Learn: Technical correctness ≠ business decision-ready. Added early metric validation, dictionary.

Pattern across all

Large-scale + migrations + reliability + mentoring · Repeatable playbooks, not heroics

Breadcrumbs you deliberately left

Don’t dump everything in intro — let interviewer pull for next 30 min

1

Unified Data Platform

“The most challenging part wasn't just the technology. It was aligning multiple business teams on common definitions”

Interviewers asks: How did you influence stakeholders who disagreed? → Story: Sales definition workshops + RACI + Metric Dictionary

2

Complex Migrations

“My experience includes leading complex data migrations”

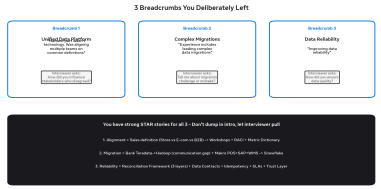
Interviewers asks: Tell me about a migration challenge or mistake → Story: Bank Teradata→Hadoop comms gap + Makro POS+SAP+WMS → Snowflake

3

Data Reliability

“Improving data reliability”

Interviewers asks: How did you ensure data quality? → Story: Reconciliation Framework 3 layers + data contracts + idempotency + Trust Layer



Strategy
Controlled depth

Control
You choose what to reveal

Signal
L6 scope + ownership

ANCHOR 5 · WHY NEXT MOVE

META — why product analytics at scale

“For my next role, I'm looking to work closer to product analytics, where data engineering directly influences product decisions. That's what interests me about Meta. The opportunity to build reliable datasets, solve complex data problems at scale, and work closely with product managers and data scientists to improve user experience.”

L6 DIFFERENTIATOR YOU MUST ADD

“I enjoy leading technical direction, but what motivates me most is solving complex data problems and seeing how those solutions improve business decisions.” — Answers unspoken question: Why would senior leader want IC DE role?

WHY THIS RESONATES AT META

Close to product
Data → PM → user experience, not just reporting

Scale problems
Reliable datasets at billions scale

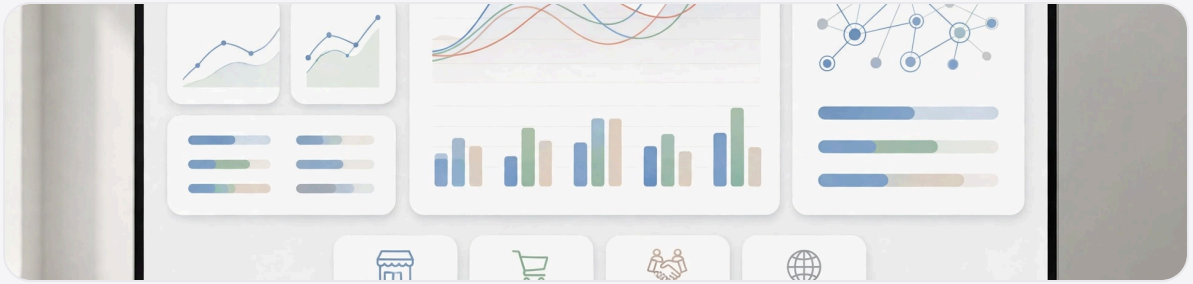
With PM + DS
Cross-functional, influence without authority

IC track L6
Hands-on + multiplier, not pure manager

INTERVIEWER THOUGHT VS YOUR ANSWER

Is he just managing?	**No — hands-on architecture + modeling**
Why Meta?	**Impact on product decisions at scale**
Why IC?	**Motivated by solving hard problems**

Multiplier **IC-track** **Product mindset**



Forget full paragraph — remember 5 words

NOW → PROJECT → IMPACT → PAST → META · 60-90 sec, then stop

ANCHOR 1

NOW

Senior Data Engineering leader in retail (Thailand, omnichannel)

Lazada-like scale, 3 businesses

ANCHOR 2

PROJECT

Unified data platform across online, offline, B2B

Fragmented → unified, domain design

ANCHOR 3

IMPACT

Faster delivery (2w→2d), trusted data, common KPIs

JIRA measured, explain how

ANCHOR 4

PAST

Bank, PayPal, SCB, Lazada — migrations + reliability

Mistake story ready: Bank 400TB

ANCHOR 5

META

Product analytics, scale, decisions

Close to product, IC track love

NOW → PROJECT → IMPACT → PAST → META

Say it in 60-90 sec, then: "That's a quick overview. Happy to go deeper into any of those." — STOP. Silence is power.

⏱️ **90 sec max**
Practice with timer, no reading

🎣 **Leave hooks**
Don't close loops — let them pull

One change I strongly recommend for L6

⚠️ **Risk: “I lead Data and AI Engineering” sounds like pure people manager**

Meta L6 DE is IC-track. If you sound only as manager, they worry you don’t love deep technical work anymore.

WHAT TO ADD — MEMORIZE VERBATIM

> *“Although I lead teams, I remain hands-on with architecture, data modeling, and solving difficult engineering problems.”*

> *“I enjoy leading technical direction, but what motivates me most is solving complex data problems and seeing how those solutions improve business decisions.”*

Architect
Owns technical direction, reviews hardest PRs

Modeler
Standardized models, metric dictionary

Solver
Hardest problems — perf, recon, idempotency

Multiplier
Makes others better via review rubric

L5 VS L6 SIGNAL

L5 red flag:
“I manage 10 engineers, I delegate all coding. I focus on people.”

L6 green:
“I lead teams but remain hands-on. I held the 3 riskiest PRs myself, taught via review.”

MULTIPLIER TEST — META EXPLICITLY SCORES

Senior DE who makes 3 juniors better is worth more than one who ships 3x code alone. Your story: Priya dbt macro open-sourced under her name, Aisha rising award — you gave credit.

Hands-on | Lift as you climb | Review as teaching | IC-track love

HOW TO CLOSE THIS POINT

Add after PAST: pause, eye contact, one line. Then continue to META. This single line fixes “people manager only” concern.

ANCHOR CLOSE · 10 SEC

Then stop speaking. Silence is power.

"That's a quick overview of my background. Happy to go deeper into any of those projects."

Or ACED original: "I can go into more detail for whatever you'd like to hear more about."

STOP

Pause · Eye contact · Let them pull breadcrumb

Interviewer now has 3 hooks to ask. You control next 30 min.

COMMON MISTAKE THAT KILLS IMPACT

- Keep talking after closing — adds laundry list of tools (Spark, Hive, Kafka...)
- No pause — fills silence with "and also..."
- Generic close — "That's it, thank you" without invitation to deeper dive

BODY LANGUAGE

Lean slightly forward, hands open, slight smile. 2-sec pause. Ready with STAR for each breadcrumb.

👁️ Eye contact ⏸️ Pause 🎣 Hooks ready



Breadcrumbs left:
Alignment · Migrations · Reliability

IF THEY PUSH ON 2 WEEKS → 2 DAYS — BE READY

If interviewer says: “How did you measure that?”

BEFORE: 10–14 days avg — last 20 JIRA		AFTER: 1.5–2.5 days avg — same JIRA type	
Clarification: no model, ad-hoc	3 days	Clarification: metric dictionary	0.5d
Dev: fragmented, no template	5 days	Dev: dbt templates + std models	1d
QA: manual, business finds bugs	4 days	QA: auto recon + dbt tests	0.5d
Deploy: manual, no CI/CD	2 days	Deploy: CI/CD	0.5d
Total	**~14 days**	**Total**	**~2 days**

ENABLERS BUILT — WHAT CHANGED

- Standardized data models (domain-driven)
- dbt macros & self-serve templates
- Data contracts with source
- Quality: Recon Framework + Trust Layer
- CI/CD

Don't claim all projects 2 days. Claim: comparable medium complexity (new dimension / KPI), measured via JIRA In Progress → Done

Good answer: “For comparable medium-complexity requests — e.g., adding a new dimension or KPI to Commercial Mart.” Show you understand measurement, not just claim.

Full ACED pitch — practice this (90 sec)

Word for word · Apple SF Pro · 60-90 sec · then STOP

NOW: "I'm a senior Data Engineering leader, currently leading Data and AI Engineering at a large omnichannel retailer in Thailand."

PROJECT: "One of my key projects was leading the design and delivery of a unified data platform across retail stores, e-commerce, and B2B businesses. When I joined, data was fragmented, metrics inconsistent, delivery slow. I worked with business + engineers to redesign architecture, standardize models, introduce reliable pipelines and quality controls."

IMPACT: "One of the biggest improvements was reducing delivery from around two weeks to two days. The most challenging part wasn't just technology — it was aligning multiple business teams on common definitions and ownership."

PAST: "Before that, I worked at Bank, PayPal, SCB, and Lazada, where I focused on large-scale data engineering, platform modernization, and analytics. Experience includes leading complex migrations, improving reliability, mentoring engineers. Although I lead teams, I remain hands-on with architecture, modeling, and hard engineering problems."

META: "For my next role, I'm looking to work closer to product analytics, where DE directly influences product decisions. That's what interests me about Meta — build reliable datasets, solve complex problems at scale, work with PMs and DSs to improve user experience. That's a quick overview. Happy to go deeper." → STOP

90 SEC PACING



NOW 10s | PROJECT 25s | IMPACT 15s | PAST 20s | META 20s

PRACTICE

Record 88-92 sec, say without reading 3x daily, focus on flow, end with 2-sec pause.

L6 FIX EMBEDDED

"Hands-on + motivated by hard problems" fixes manager-only worry. Multiplier + IC love.

ACED = CONTROL

NOW → PROJECT → IMPACT → PAST → META = You control what interviewer hears in first 90 sec.

VISUAL · WHAT INTERVIEWER HEARS

ACED flow — what interviewer hears in 90 sec

5 boxes = 5 signals. Below each: interviewer's internal question. Center: breadcrumbs = hooks for next 30 min.

NOW
Senior DE Leader
Thailand Omnichannel
Scope: 3 businesses

→

PROJECT
Unified Platform
Stores+E-com+B2B
Fragmented → Unified

IMPACT
2w → 2d delivery
Trusted data
Common KPIs

→

PAST
Bank, PayPal, SC
Lazada —
migrations+reliability

→

META
Product Analytics
Scale+Decisions
Why Meta?

NOW	Is he senior enough for L6?
PROJECT	Did he own architecture?
IMPACT	Can he measure?
PAST	Has he done scale before?
META	Why does he want IC role?

Breadcrumbs left: Alignment (common definitions) | Migrations (Bank mistake) | Reliability (reconciliation)
Close with: "Happy to go deeper into any of those" → STOP

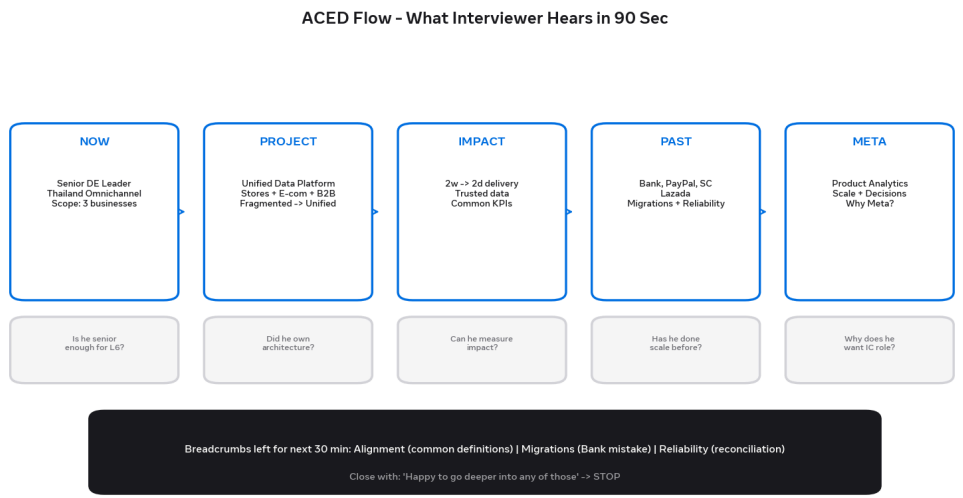


Diagram: 5-box ACED flow — NOW who you are → PROJECT what you built → IMPACT proof → PAST credibility → META why here

BEFORE YOU WALK IN · ACED SUCCESS

Final checklist — are you ready?

1. **Can you say NOW → PROJECT → IMPACT → PAST → META in 90 sec without reading?**
   Record, time it. No laundry list. One breath per anchor.

2. **Can you explain 2w → 2d measurement with JIRA data?**
   Comparable medium complexity mart change, avg last 20 tickets. Not all projects.

3. **Can you tell alignment story (sales definition) in 60 sec?**
   Store vs E-com vs B2B → Workshops + RACI + Metric Dictionary co-owned

4. **Can you map each breadcrumb to a STAR story?**
   Migration mistake = Bank (comms gap), Reliability = Makro recon 3 layers, Alignment = Makro sales

5. **Can you say L6 differentiator hands-on?**
   "Lead but remain hands-on, motivated by solving complex problems that improve business decisions"

6. **Do you stop after "Happy to go deeper..." and let them pull?**
   Silence is power. Don't ramble. 2-sec pause, eye contact, ready.

✅ **If yes x6 → You are ready** · This is closer to ACED example than generic Present-Past-Future

Apple SF Pro · #F5F5F7 minimal · Senior DE → Meta L6 · Memorize 5 words